100 ORIGINAL STARTING POINTS

Your stories.
Your next *first line.*

100 hook templates for professionals, freelancers, business owners and people ready to start sharing.

You don't need a dramatic life story. Begin with something you've noticed, learned, tried or changed your mind about.

Make the template yours

1. Choose a real experience or useful idea first.
2. Pick a first line that fits it. Replace every bracket with a specific detail.
3. Deliver what the opening promises. Remove anything you can't honestly support.

Original prompts by Ray Chua. These are creative starting points, not tested promises of views, clients or income. No fabricated stories, testimonials or results needed.

HOOKS 001–010

Your starting point

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

001	Before I knew anything about [topic], I kept getting stuck on [specific problem].
002	The first time I tried [activity], the part I struggled with wasn't [expected difficulty].
003	I didn't start [project] feeling ready. I started with [small action].
004	At [stage of life], I thought [belief]. Then [experience] changed my mind.
005	My earliest attempt at [skill] taught me something I still use today.
006	If you're starting [activity] with only [limited resource], here's where I'd begin.
007	I wish I'd understood [lesson] before my first [experience].
008	The question I was too embarrassed to ask about [topic] was [question].
009	Here's what [task] actually looked like when I was a beginner.
010	I used to wait for [condition] before trying [activity]. This helped me take the first step.

HOOKS 011–020

Lessons from real life

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

011	A conversation about [ordinary subject] made me rethink [bigger idea].
012	I learned more about [skill] from [unexpected experience] than I expected.
013	[Everyday moment] reminded me why [principle] matters.
014	One detail from [experience] has stayed with me: [detail].
015	I handled [situation] differently this time. Here's what I changed.
016	Something went wrong during [activity]. The useful part came afterwards.
017	I thought the lesson from [experience] was [first interpretation]. Now I see it as [new interpretation].
018	A small decision during [project] changed how I approach [task].
019	This is the part of [experience] I would repeat—and the part I wouldn't.
020	If I could leave a note for myself before [event], it would say [message].

HOOKS 021–030

What you believe

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

021	I care more about [priority] than [common priority] when I'm doing [work].
022	My view on [topic] changed after I saw [specific observation].
023	I agree with [advice]—until [important exception].
024	[Popular approach] works for some people. Here's why I choose [alternative].
025	There's a difference between [concept A] and [concept B] that matters in [context].
026	For me, doing [activity] well means [personal definition].
027	I don't think [common metric] tells the whole story of [goal].
028	Here's a belief about [topic] I'm still questioning.
029	I used to judge [choice] differently before I understood [context].
030	When people disagree about [topic], I think they're often solving different problems.

HOOKS 031–040

Explain your expertise

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

031	When someone asks me about [topic], I start with this question: [question].
032	If [term] sounds confusing, picture [simple comparison].
033	You can tell a lot about [situation] by looking at [specific signal].
034	Here's how I explain [concept] to someone encountering it for the first time.
035	Before choosing [tool or approach], check [relevant condition].
036	The part of [process] people see is [visible part]. The part that makes it work is [less visible part].
037	When [problem] happens, I check [factor] before changing [other factor].
038	Here's one way to practise [skill] using something you already have.
039	If you understand [basic idea], [complex idea] becomes easier to follow.
040	To make sense of [topic], separate [element A] from [element B].

HOOKS 041–050

Behind your work

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

041	This is what happens between [starting point] and [finished output].
042	Before I start [task], I spend a moment on [preparation].
043	The least glamorous part of my [work or routine] is also one of the most useful.
044	I made this choice in [piece of work] because [reason].
045	Here's something I removed from [project] and why it didn't belong.
046	This rough draft shows the decision that shaped the final [output].
047	A normal day working on [activity] includes more [unexpected task] than you might think.
048	When I'm stuck on [task], this is the next thing I try.
049	The tool I use for [job] matters less than how I [specific action].
050	Come with me while I work through one small part of [project].

HOOKS 051–060

Help someone feel understood

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

051	If [task] keeps moving to tomorrow, what's making it hard to start?
052	You can know a lot about [topic] and still feel unsure about [action].
053	The awkward part of [new activity] that I rarely hear people discuss is [detail].
054	If you keep rewriting [thing], try deciding [one boundary] first.
055	When [challenge] feels overwhelming, I shrink the next step to [action].
056	You don't have to share [private detail] to talk honestly about [lesson].
057	If [common advice] doesn't fit your life, here's a smaller option to consider.
058	I recognise that feeling of [emotion] before [activity]. This is what helps me.
059	Not being able to do [large task] today doesn't rule out [small task].
060	Before you call yourself [negative label], look at what [task] is asking of you.

HOOKS 061–070

Decisions and trade-offs

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

061	I chose [option A] over [option B] for this project. Here was the trade-off.
062	Both [approach A] and [approach B] can work. I'd choose based on [condition].
063	Here are the questions I'd ask before spending time on [activity].
064	If your priority is [goal], [choice] may matter more than [other choice].
065	One reason I stopped using [approach] was [specific limitation].
066	I keep [habit] simple so I can spend more attention on [priority].
067	Before saying yes to [opportunity], I wanted to understand [detail].
068	Choosing [option] solved [problem], but it introduced [new challenge].
069	I would use [method] for [context], but reconsider it for [different context].
070	The decision wasn't whether [option] was good. It was whether it suited [situation].

HOOKS 071–080

Questions worth answering

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

071	Someone asked me, "[real question]". Here's the part I'd answer first.
072	What would you do if [specific situation]? Here's how I'd think it through.
073	Can you [goal] without [assumed requirement]? It depends on [condition].
074	How do you know when [task] is ready? I look for [criterion].
075	What should a beginner notice about [topic]? Start with [detail].
076	Why does [recurring problem] keep happening? One possibility is [explanation].
077	When is [popular advice] actually useful? Here's the context I'd look for.
078	If I had only [time available] for [activity], what would I prioritise?
079	What's worth keeping when you simplify [process]?
080	How would I approach [task] differently if [constraint] changed?

HOOKS 081–090

Progress without hype

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

081	I'm still learning [skill]. Here's one thing I can do now that I couldn't before.
082	This isn't the finished version of [project]. It's the next version.
083	I tried [change] during [period]. Here's what I noticed—and what I can't conclude yet.
084	The clearest sign of progress in my [activity] wasn't a number. It was [observable change].
085	I'm keeping [part of approach] and changing [other part] after this attempt.
086	Looking back at [earlier work], I can see where my thinking has changed.
087	I expected [outcome] from [attempt]. What actually happened was [observation].
088	One adjustment made [specific task] easier for me: [adjustment].
089	Here's what I know so far about [ongoing project], and what I'm still testing.
090	I'm sharing this before it feels polished because [honest reason].

HOOKS 091–100

Your work and the people it helps

Choose a line that fits something you can genuinely speak about.

091	People often come to [your work] wanting [surface goal]. First, I ask about [underlying need].
092	If you're considering help with [task], here's what working together would involve.
093	A useful brief for [service] starts with [information], not [common starting point].
094	The part of [service] I want people to understand before they enquire is [expectation].
095	Here's what you bring to [collaboration], and what I help with.
096	One thing I can help with is [specific deliverable]. Here's what that means in practice.
097	[Service] may be a fit if you're dealing with [problem] and want [realistic support].
098	Before we talk about [deliverable], I want to understand [person's context].
099	This is the question I'd encourage you to ask anyone offering [service].
100	If you want support with [task], you can start by telling me [simple next step].

FROM FIRST LINE TO FIRST POST

Keep it *honest.* Keep it useful.

Before you record

- Does this sound like something I would actually say?
- Can I fulfil the opening with one clear story, explanation or demonstration?
- Am I presenting personal experience as personal experience?
- Have I removed private details or obtained permission to share them?

Use the companion format guide to give your idea a shape. A strong opening introduces something worth hearing; it doesn't replace the substance.

Try a small batch. Notice which topics bring thoughtful replies and relevant conversations, not only views. Performance varies; no single hook works for everyone.

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